

MAXIME ROCHE

Economics of Food, Nutrition, Agriculture, and the Environment
Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation
Department of Economics & Public Policy
Imperial College London

PERSONAL DATA

NATIONALITY AND YEAR OF BIRTH: French | 1993
EMAIL: m.roche21@imperial.ac.uk
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EDUCATION

2022-2026 PhD Candidate in ECONOMICS & PUBLIC POLICY, **Imperial College London** – UK
Advisors: Prof. Franco SASSI, Dr. Laure DE PREUX

2021-2022 Awarded **Distinction** for MRes in ECONOMICS & PUBLIC POLICY
Imperial College London – UK

2017-2018 Master of Sc. in ECONOMICS, **University of Amsterdam** – Netherlands

2013-2017 Master of Sc. in CORPORATE FINANCE & BANKING, **EDHEC Business School**
Master in MANAGEMENT, **EDHEC Business School**
Bachelor's degree in BUSINESS MANAGEMENT, **EDHEC Business School** – France

2011-2013 Preparatory classes in MATHEMATICS & PHYSICS for the entrance exams to top
French engineer & business schools, **Lycee Joffre (Montpellier)** – France

VISITING

SPRING 2025 Visiting researcher, hosted by DR. ARIEL ORTIZ BOBEA
Cornell University, Dyson School of Applied Economics & Management – NY, USA

SPRING 2016 Exchange semester in Master in ECONOMICS & PUBLIC POLICY
Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez – Chile

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Food Policy, Health Economics, Agricultural Economics, Environmental Economics

PEER-REVIEWED ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

- [Can differentiated value-added tax rates promote healthier diets? The case of Costa Rica](#)
(*Food Policy*, 2025)

WORKING PAPERS

- [How is climate fuelling the thirst for sweetness? Exploring drivers and adaptation](#), *Chicago Booth Kilts Center for Marketing Data Center Paper Series*, with Laure de Preux (ICL)

- [Taxation of foods high in fat, sugar, and sodium in India: A modelling study of health and economic impacts](#), Revise & Resubmit at *PLOS Medicine*, with Jingmin Zhu (ICL), Jack Olney (ICL), Daniel J Laydon (ICL), William Joe (IEG), Manika Sharma (RTSL), Lindsay Steele (RTSL), & Franco Sassi (ICL)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **The Future of Food Demand: Global Meta-Analysis and Projections of Income and Price Elasticities**, with Andrew Comstock (IFPRI) & Olivier Ecker (IFPRI)
- **Hot Weather and Undernutrition in Sub-Saharan Africa: Vulnerabilities, Mechanisms, and Adaptation**, solo-authored

SELECTED PEER-REVIEWED POLICY PUBLICATIONS

- [Comparing taxes as a percentage of sugar-sweetened beverage prices in Latin America and the Caribbean](#) (*The Lancet Regional Health - Americas*, 2023)
AUTHORS: **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Miriam Alvarado (Cambridge), Rosa Sandoval (PAHO), Fabio da Silva Gomes (PAHO), Guillermo Paraje (UAI)
- [Comparing taxes on alcoholic beverages in the Region of the Americas](#) (*Addiction*, 2023)
AUTHORS: **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Rosa Sandoval (PAHO), Maristela Monteiro (PAHO)

POLICY BOOK CHAPTERS

- [United Nations. Handbook on Health Taxes for Developing Countries](#). Chapter 13: Specific Issues with respect to Taxation to Support Improved Nutrition (*accepted, forthcoming 2026*).
AUTHORS: Anne-Marie Thow (U Sidney), **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Libby Hattersley (World Bank), Kate Mandeville (World Bank)
- [United Nations. Handbook on Health Taxes for Developing Countries](#). Chapter 9: Interaction between Health Taxes and other Instruments (*accepted, forthcoming 2026*).
AUTHORS: Franco Sassi (ICL), **Maxime Roche (ICL)**
- [World Health Organization. Health taxes: Policy and practice](#). Chapter 10: Monitoring and measuring health taxes (*World Scientific*, 2023)
AUTHORS: Rosa Sandoval (PAHO), **Maxime Roche (ICL)**, Anne-Marie Perucic (WHO), Itziar Belausteguigoitia (WHO), Miriam Alvarado (Cambridge), Luis Galicia (MoH URY), Guillermo Paraje (UAI)

ACADEMIC CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

2025 American Economic Association annual meeting (ASSA, *Invited to present*); International Food Policy Research Institute (seminar, *Invited to present*); European Association of Agricultural Economists (EAAE, *Presentation*) congress; Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) summer conference (*Presentation*); Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research (PIK)'s DENeB PhD Workshop 'Climate Change, Agriculture, and Health' (*Presentation*); Columbia University's Interdisciplinary PhD Workshop in Sustainable Development (*Presentation*); University of Costa Rica's School of Economics (*Presentation*)

2024 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) (*Presentation*); Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE) (*Presentation*); European Health Economics Association (EuHEA) (*Presentation*); Canadian Economics Association (CEA) (*Presentation*); French Economists Association (AFSE) (*Presentation*); Maastricht University's Workshop on Applied Economics of the Environment (*Presentation*); University of Goettingen's Sustainable Food Systems Symposium (*Presentation*); Imperial College London's Economics & Public Policy (*Presentation*)

2023 International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) ‘Delivering for Nutrition in South Asia’ (*Presentation*); University of Warwick ‘Quantitative Methods in Social Sciences’ (*Presentation*); University of Birmingham’s Health Economics Unit (*Presentation*); University of Costa Rica’s School of Nutrition (*Presentation*); Imperial College London’s Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation (*Presentation*); Imperial College London’s Public Health Policy Evaluation Unit (*Presentation*)

SELECTED POLICY PRESENTATIONS

- **UK Department of Health & Social Care & World Health Organization, Regional Office for Europe**, Sugar and Calorie Reduction Network meeting: Fiscal levers (London, UK, 2025)
- **Pan American Health Organization**, Health tax policies in Latin America and the Caribbean: Are we making progress? (virtual, 2022, [link](#))
- **European Commission and ICF**, Mapping of fiscal measures and pricing policies applied to food, non-alcoholic and alcoholic beverages (virtual presentation, 2022, [link](#))
- **Congress of Paraguay**, Noncommunicable diseases: Scientific evidence for the use of fiscal policies for health (in Spanish) (Asuncion, Paraguay, 2019, [link](#))

INVITED REFEREE

JOURNALS Applied Economics; Food Policy; The Lancet Public Health; PLOS One; Climatic Change

CONFERENCES EAAE 2025; EAYE 2025; EuHEA 2024

OTHER PARTICIPATIONS & CONTRIBUTIONS

MEMBERSHIPS American Economic Association; European Health Economics Association
Agricultural & Applied Economics Association; Association of Environmental & Resource Economists; United Nations’ Subcommittee on Health Taxes

COURSES University of Copenhagen’s Department of Food and Resource Economics
‘International PhD course: Food and health policy analysis using home-scan data’ (Copenhagen, Denmark, Dec 2023);
BREAD-IGC ‘Virtual PhD course on Environmental Economics’ (virtual, 2023)

OTHER Global Fellows Programme: ‘Data for sustainability’ (NTU Singapore, 2023);
United Nations’ Subcommittee on Health Taxes meeting (Geneva, 2025)

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

2021-2025 London Interdisciplinary Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership,
UK Economic and Social Research Council
4-year: Full tuition + Full-time stipend allowance + Research & Training funds

2025 Imperial College London’s Global Fellows Fund
Turing Scheme
Overseas research funding $\approx$ GBP 1,700

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

FEB 2025 - present	Research assistant, Foresight & Policy Modeling Unit International Food Policy Research Institute , Washington DC (remote)
JUN 2023 - MAR 2024	Research assistant, Centre for Health Economics & Policy Innovation Imperial College London , London
APR 2022 - JUL 2023	Consultant, Fiscal Policies for Health team World Health Organization , Geneva (remote)
MAR 2019 - AUG 2021	Consultant, Economics of Noncommunicable Diseases team Pan American Health Organization , Washington DC
DEC 2018 - MAR 2019	Consultant, Health, Nutrition & Population Global Practice, World Bank , Washington DC
SEP 2015 - FEB 2016	Intern, Financial audit KPMG , Paris

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

FALL 2024 & 2025	Tutorial leader, MICROECONOMICS 2 (student feedback : 4.7/5) BSc Economics, Finance & Data Science; Imperial College London Course leader: Prof. Tommaso Valletti (t.valletti@imperial.ac.uk)
FALL 2024	Teaching Assistant, HEALTH ECONOMICS (student feedback : 4.8/5) MSc Global Health Management; Imperial College London Course leader: Prof. Marisa Miraldo (m.miraldo@imperial.ac.uk)
ACADEMIC YEAR 2017-2018	Teacher, MATHEMATICS FOR ECONOMICS & FINANCE University of Amsterdam, ONCAMPUS Cambridge Education Course leader: Evgenia Papoula (epapoula@oncampus.global)

LANGUAGES

FRENCH: Mothertongue
ENGLISH: Fluent
SPANISH: Fluent

COMPUTER SKILLS

Advanced Knowledge: STATA, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Microsoft Office Suite
Working Knowledge: VBA, Tableau

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Professor Franco Sassi	Imperial College London	f.sassi@imperial.ac.uk
Dr Laure de Preux	Imperial College London	l.depreux@imperial.ac.uk
Professor Marisa Miraldo	Imperial College London	m.miraldo@imperial.ac.uk